PADHAKU
Exploring Society: India and Beyond · Class 6 Social Science



CHAPTER 13

The Value of Work

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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? The Big Questions

1 What are the different types of activities that people engage in?

✔ ANSWER

People engage in two types of activities:

- **Economic activities:** done for money or money's worth, e.g. a farmer selling produce, a lawyer earning a fee, a truck driver transporting goods, workers in a car factory.
- **Non-economic activities:** done without money, out of love, care, gratitude or respect, e.g. parents cooking for the family, youth caring for grandparents, sevā, Swachh Bharat cleaning drives.

2 What is their contribution to our everyday lives?

✔ ANSWER

- Economic activities give people **income** and give us the goods and services we need (food, clothes, transport, schooling, health care). They also **add value** to things (wood → chair).
- Non-economic activities build **care, love and community feeling**. They add to social welfare, personal wellbeing and the overall quality of life (e.g. langars, clean surroundings, tree planting).

Let's Explore · Activities in Anu's and Kabir's story

1 **What activities did the people in Anu's and Kabir's story engage in? Mention them in the table.**

✔ ANSWER

Character in the story	Activities they are engaged in
Geeta Aunty	Pilot in the Indian Air Force
Kabir's grandfather	Retired from the Border Security Force; gives free Geography classes to neighbourhood kids, tends the vegetable garden, runs errands for the home
Parents who run a shop (Appa and Maa)	Run a shop that sells uniforms and ready-made garments
Maa who is back home before school ends	Contributes to a voluntary group that teaches stitching to women in the community
Rohan (Anu's elder brother)	Software engineer in a company that makes computer applications; on weekends volunteers to teach computer skills in the youth development programme of a college

⭐ Let's Explore · Economic or non-economic?

1 **Label the third column of the table 'economic / non-economic activity' and classify the activities.**

✔ ANSWER

Character	Activity	Economic / Non-economic
Geeta Aunty	Air Force pilot (gets a salary)	**Economic**
Kabir's grandfather	Free Geography classes, gardening, errands	**Non-economic**
Parents with the shop	Selling uniforms and garments	**Economic**
Maa in the voluntary group	Teaching stitching to women (voluntary)	**Non-economic**
Rohan	Software engineer (gets a salary)	**Economic**
Rohan	Teaching computer skills as a volunteer	**Non-economic**

🤔 Think About It · Economic and non-economic activities

1 **When Kabir's grandfather voluntarily teaches the neighbourhood kids for free, is that an economic or a non-economic activity? How is**

it different from your teachers teaching you at school?

✔ ANSWER

It is a **non-economic activity**, because he takes no money; he teaches out of care for the children.

Our school teachers are paid a **salary** for teaching, so their teaching is an **economic activity**. The work is the same (teaching), but one is paid and the other is free.

2 **What are some non-economic activities that are important to you and your family? Why are they valuable?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Cooking meals and eating together.
- Helping younger siblings with homework.
- Looking after grandparents when they are ill.
- Cleaning and decorating the house together for festivals.

They are valuable because they show love and care, keep the family healthy and happy, and bring us closer, even though no money is earned.

🤔 Think About It · Economic activities on the way to school

1 **On your way from home to school today, can you recall the various economic activities**

that people are engaged in? In what ways do you think those people are paid?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Shopkeepers and vegetable sellers selling goods: earn money from sales (profit).
- Auto-rickshaw, bus and taxi drivers: get fares or a monthly salary.
- Construction labourers: get a daily **wage**.
- Traffic police, post office staff, teachers: get a monthly **salary**.
- A doctor in a clinic: gets a **fee**.
- A farm labourer may get part of the payment as crops: **payment in kind**.

⭐ Let's Explore · Activities that create monetary value

1 **Put a ✓ against activities/professions that create monetary value. Add two activities with examples in the empty rows.**
1. Baker 2. Tailor 3. Farmers repairing their tractor 4. Doctor 5. Parents cooking dinner for their family 6. Scientist 7. Person taking care of a sick grandparent 8. ___ 9. ___

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Activity / Profession	✓	Example of money-related value creation
1. Baker	✓	Turns flour, sugar and butter into bread and cakes and sells them for more

2. Tailor	✓	Stitches cloth into clothes and charges for the stitching
3. Farmers repairing their tractor	✓	The repaired tractor is used to grow crops that are sold (if they pay a mechanic, that also involves money)
4. Doctor	✓	Treats patients and gets a fee or salary
5. Parents cooking dinner for their family	×	Done out of love; no money involved
6. Scientist	✓	Does research for a salary; discoveries are used to make new products
7. Person taking care of a sick grandparent	×	Done out of care; no money involved
8. Carpenter	✓	Buys wood for ₹600 and sells a chair for ₹1,000
9. Potter	✓	Makes pots from clay and sells them in the market

🤔 Think About It · Community participation

1 **Many communities in India have similar practices that involve community participation. Can you identify a few from your area?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Langar or bhandara where food is cooked and served to all for free.

- Cleanliness drives in the colony under Swachh Bharat Abhiyan.
- Tree plantation on Van Mahotsav.
- Neighbours helping together at weddings and festivals.
- Blood donation camps and help during floods or other disasters.

2 **During festivals people gather to organise activities, decorate the place together and share the food that they cook. Are these non-economic activities? Why do you think they still hold value?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Yes, decorating together and cooking and sharing food are **non-economic activities**, because they are done out of joy, love and respect, not for money.

They still hold value because they bring people together, build friendship and unity, keep our traditions alive and make everyone happy.

3 **Can you identify community programmes that have been undertaken by your school or in your locality? What did you observe during these programmes?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- Our school held a cleanliness drive and a tree plantation drive on Van Mahotsav.

- Our locality held a free health check-up camp.

I observed that students, teachers, parents and neighbours worked together happily without any payment. Everyone felt proud, and the area became cleaner and greener.

? Questions, activities and projects

1 How are economic activities different from non-economic activities?

✔ ANSWER

Economic activities	Non-economic activities
Involve money or money's worth	Do not involve money
Done to earn income or wealth	Done out of love, care, gratitude or respect
Paid as salary, wage, fee or payment in kind	No payment is expected
Add value in money (₹600 wood → ₹1,000 chair)	Add to social welfare and wellbeing
e.g. farmer selling crops, lawyer earning a fee	e.g. parents cooking for family, langar sevā

2 What kind of economic activities do people engage in? Illustrate with examples.

✔ ANSWER

- **Selling goods:** a business person selling school bags, a farmer selling produce, a shop selling uniforms.
- **Providing services:** a lawyer arguing a case, a doctor treating patients, a teacher or tutor, a post office employee, a truck driver transporting goods.
- **Jobs for a salary:** a pilot in the Air Force, a software engineer, a bulldozer operator in a construction company.
- **Making things (adding value):** workers in a car factory; a carpenter who buys wood for ₹600 and sells a chair for ₹1,000.
- **Working for a wage:** a farm labourer like Sahil who tills land and is paid in cash and mangoes.

3 **There is great value attached to people who are engaged in community service activities. Comment on this statement.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

I agree. People doing community service work **without expecting anything in return** (sevā).

- Langars feed every visitor for free.
- Swachh Bharat drives keep streets and parks clean; Van Mahotsav plants trees.
- Volunteers like Kabir's grandfather and Rohan teach others for free.

Such work improves social welfare and quality of life, builds unity and gives a sense of satisfaction and gratitude. So these people are respected and valued, even though they earn no money.

4 **What are the various ways in which people are compensated for various economic activities? Give some examples.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Salary:** fixed regular payment, usually monthly, by an employer. e.g. Geeta Aunty (pilot), Rohan (software engineer), Kavya's uncle (bulldozer operator), Kavya's aunt (post office).
- **Wage:** payment for a specific period of time, e.g. Sahil, the farm labourer, earns a **daily wage**.
- **Fee:** payment for professional advice or services, e.g. a doctor, a lawyer; Kavya's aunt charges a weekly fee for online classes.
- **Payment in kind:** non-cash payment, e.g. Sahil gets part of his payment as mangoes.
- **Selling goods:** money from sales, e.g. Rajesh sells chairs for ₹1,000 each.

🎉 **Chapter 13 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**